POWERPLAY — Ladder & Turn Reference

Everything you need at the table for your turn: the Activation Ladder, PowerPlay!, Power Floors, Reactions, and where your turn sits in the round.

Your Turn: The Inbox → Action → Organize the Desk

1. The Inbox

At the start of your turn, you may buy:

- up to **1 Action card** for **2 Coins**, and
- up to **1 Reaction card** for **1 Coin**.

For each buy, draw the top 2 cards of that deck, keep 1, discard the other. This is the only place cards are bought — the Opening Bell refill is free.

2. Action

Take **exactly 1 Standard Action** (you may leave it unused): **play an Action card**. It is free to play. Its effect resolves and your Assets fire through the Activation Ladder below.

Free Actions (do not use your Standard Action):

- **Character Ability** — free, needs 2 Power (checked, not spent), once per round, only in the phase printed on your character card.
- **PowerPlay!** — see below. Once per turn.

3. Organize the Desk

- **Attach cleanup:** remove any expired attached cards from your Assets and from yourself. A Freeze is an attached card — removing it here is how a Frozen Asset unfreezes.
- No per-turn discard: your hand refills to 3 Action / 2 Reaction at the next Opening Bell.

Activation Ladder

Playing a card fires **your own Assets'** Synergies by matching Industry. Action cards carry a primary and a secondary Industry.

Step	Cost	What fires
Base	Free, with the card play	**2 of your Assets** matching the card's **primary Industry**
Influencing Decision *(optional)*	**1 Influence**	The **secondary Industry unlocks**, and **1 more Asset** fires from either Industry — **3 fires total**

- Each Asset fires **at most once** per card play, and only if you meet its Power Floor.
- Fewer matching Assets than fires? Fire what you have; the rest are lost. No matching Assets? The card's effect still resolves.
- You may declare the Influencing Decision only if you hold 1 Influence when you play the card.
- **Reactions:** playing a Reaction fires **1 of your Assets** matching its Industry — no cost, no ladder.

Resolving fires: fires resolve **one at a time, in the order you choose**. Before each fire resolves, the player it targets may play a Reaction; the targeted player always gets first say before anyone else defends them. If several players want to react to the same fire, the one earliest in turn order from the Leader goes first.

PowerPlay!

Pay **1 Power** on your own turn (once per turn) to:

- play **up to 2 Action cards** this turn;

- get the **Influencing Decision free on one of them** (the other may still buy it for 1 Influence);
- **draw 1 Action card and 1 Reaction card**;
- declare **up to 2 of your Asset fires Sacred** — say so when the fire triggers, before any Reaction is committed against it.

PowerPlay! itself is **Sacred**. A Sacred play opens **no response window at all** — no Reaction of any kind can be played against it.

Power Track & Power Floors

Power is **checked, not spent**, unless a card says to pay it. Track it on the Power Track dial; the labelled rungs are your unlocks:

Power	Unlocks
1	PowerPlay!
2	Tier 2 Assets (buy and use) · Character Ability
3	Tier 3 Assets (buy and use)

Action and Reaction cards have **no Power Floor** — they are always free to play. If your Power drops below an Asset's floor, its Synergy is locked until you climb back; it still pays income.

Reactions (out of turn)

- Play a Reaction **only in response** to an Action card, a single Asset Synergy fire, or an Event — never unprompted on your own turn.
- **Any Reaction can answer any Action or any single fire.** A 3-fire Action offers up to 3 separate chances to react.
- Reactions **mitigate** — they reduce or compensate; they do not cancel.
- **No Reaction to a Reaction.** The chain ends at the first Reaction.
- The player who plays the Reaction is the **Reactor** — you may defend yourself or another targeted player, and your own matching Asset fires either way.

The Round at a Glance

One round is one fiscal quarter; the game is **4 rounds** (8 turns per player). Each phase runs in turn order from the Leader.

1. **Morning News** — draw and read one Event; resolve it. It stays active until the next Morning News.
2. **Opening Bell** — each player: discard any cards, refill free to 3 Action / 2 Reaction; roll income (D4 per Tier 1 Asset, D6 per Tier 2, D10 per Tier 3), pay Operating Costs (Tier 2: 1 Coin, Tier 3: 2 Coins per Asset), collect. Income Reroll: pay 2 Coins to reroll one die.
3. **Market Operation** — sealed-bid Asset draft. Opt in; each participant pulls one Asset into a shared row (Tier 2 needs 2 Power + 4 Coins; Tier 3 needs 3 Power + 7 Coins). Secret Coin bids, revealed together; highest bid picks first and pays the bid (minimum half printed cost: 2 / 4 / 7). Leftovers go to the bottom of their decks.
4. **First turns** — every player takes a turn (The Inbox → Action → Organize the Desk).
5. **Lunch Break** — in order: **Afternoon News** (second Event; active until the next Afternoon News) → **Loans** (borrow half an unmortgaged Asset's printed cost; it becomes Mortgaged) → **Trading Window** (two-party deals; cards, Assets, Coins, IOUs; max 2 deals per player) → **Private Equity** (pay 1 / 2 / 3 Coins by tier, draw 2 from that Asset deck, buy 1 at printed cost) → **Sells** (sell an unmortgaged Asset for printed cost).
6. **Second turns** — every player takes their second turn.
7. **Call-it-a-Night** — **Currency Conversion** (3 Coins = 1 Influence · 2 Influence = 1 Power; your own resources only) → **Debt Settlement** (loan repayment at principal + 1 Coin, 1 Coin maintenance per active loan, IOU settlement) → **Thievery** (if the player with the lowest Power is not the Leader, they take the Leader Token and give it to any player).

After the final round: settle every outstanding loan (Clean the Books), then score at the Board Meeting:

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Total Power = Power + floor(Influence ÷ 2) + floor(Coins ÷ 6) + floor(Total Asset Value ÷ 5)
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